Return on Experience (ROX)

A marketer's guide to measuring (*and making the case for*) the holistic value of real-world experiences.

PART and SUM

VTProDesign

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It's getting harder for brands to not only make an impact but also measure that impact.

In a world of endless noise and ever-evolving consumer expectations, marketers must strike a delicate balance: they need to drive innovation at the speed of culture while staying grounded in authenticity, consumer-centricity, and efforts to grow advocates

Traditional marketing metrics are often failing to paint the full picture when it comes to measuring the value of modern tactics. Brands must find new ways of measurement that account for not only short-term performance, but also long-term impact on brand equity, customer loyalty, cultural relevance, and sales.



Experience has emerged as the most powerful way to create meaningful connection.

"Experiences allow the audience to be the main character in a way that other tactics will never be able to do. In an experience, you are the hero: you get to keep that memory, and you never forget how it made you feel."

—Michelle Higa Fox
Group Creative Director of Experience
BUCK

By inviting audiences to participate in immersive, personalized **IRL experiences** that show the brand's values in action, brands create opportunities to forge unique and lasting memories that hold real emotional resonance.

Still, some marketers might not be convinced; favoring passive marketing tactics in the hopes of achieving greater scale. But if the true ROI of an experience could be actively measured, then so could the true impact of experience be proven.

Imagine if you could prove the value of fostering active engagement, deepening brand affinity, and driving sustained advocacy.

First and foremost: What exactly do we mean when we say “Experience”?

Experience is a **holistic** and **audience-centric** way of thinking about real-world, in-person activations.

Experience is not just the event itself, nor the content generated from it; it encompasses the methods used to make that event an emotionally-resonant memory for participants that extends well beyond any tentpole moment.

“Initially, a lot of stuff was designed for Instagram, where environments were flat 2D elements that people could take pictures with, but not actually experience. And then experiences like Sleep No More and Meow Wolf prioritised the person before the social takeaway asset. And in the long-term this has been way more successful.”

—Paul Elsberg
Group Business Director
VTPro

TLDR:
If an **event** is the equivalent of watching *Dune* on your laptop, then an **experience** would be like watching it in IMAX.

"We 'event-asize' movies, people want to shoot their movies in IMAX ... because it means that it's a quality movie. It's a big blockbuster."

—Mark Welton
President
IMAX Theatres

Experience has the power to transcend into culture.



In the strongest cases, when a brand's values align clearly and authentically with its audience, an experience transcends the temporary moment and enters culture – becoming a shared reference point in our collective consciousness. This generation of cultural capital unlocks long-term brand equity that performance metrics simply cannot replicate.

Being able to accomplish this, requires new ways of thinking, creating, and measuring experience itself.

In Focus: Apple TV *Severance*

IMMERSION AND INTERACTION DRAWS THE AUDIENCE FURTHER INTO THE STORY

To promote the second season of Apple TV+'s acclaimed series *Severance*, a striking and immersive pop-up event was staged at New York City's Grand Central Terminal.
The event recreated the show's iconic office, featuring both the actual cast and detailed props from the series.

The event was one of a series of experiences meant to promote the show's second season. While Season 1 had entered fan lexicon and built up an engaged community, the lead-up to Season 2 leveraged the physical world to activate that community, effectively blurring the lines between fiction and reality and creating excitement around the premiere.

A Surprise Event With Digital Buzz

The event itself had no public announcements, so commuters learned about the installation in real time, amplifying the sense of spontaneity and excitement. However, there were coinciding out-of-the-ordinary digital moments that promoted the show across Apple's website, even on pages unrelated to the show.

Authenticity Leads and Fans Follow

The pop-up featured a glass cube replicating the show set, complete with authentic props, and the show's actors interacted with the fans, drawing a large crowd of engaged spectators who wouldn't want to miss out on the moment.

Shareable Moments and Online Interaction

The installation inspired visitors to take photos and videos, which were widely shared across social channels, further cementing the success of the real life experience while extending its life online. Lumon Industries, the fictional company in the show, also launched a LinkedIn page, sending out in-universe emails and further integrating the show's narrative into real-world digital spaces.









In Focus: Kendrick Lamar's Super Bowl Halftime Show

HOW CREATIVITY TURNS EXPERIENCE INTO ENDURING CULTURAL SIGNIFICANCE

In February 2025, Kendrick Lamar electrified the Super Bowl through a culturally-charged, meta-experience halftime show that became the most watched in NFL history, garnering more views than the game itself. Lamar's performance wasn't just entertainment, but a cultural thesis that set the internet ablaze, catalyzed Reddit theories and spawned viral dances on TikTok. It was a performance engineered for endless dissection and debate.

Creativity Pays Back

A common misconception is that a memorable experience must break banks and wow audiences through special effects. Unlike the intricate special effects and stunts of past halftime shows, Lamar stood out by focusing on storytelling and artistry, and his subdued production paid out in the end; seeing a 900% surge in streaming plays, and a nearly sold-out national tour that kicked off this month.

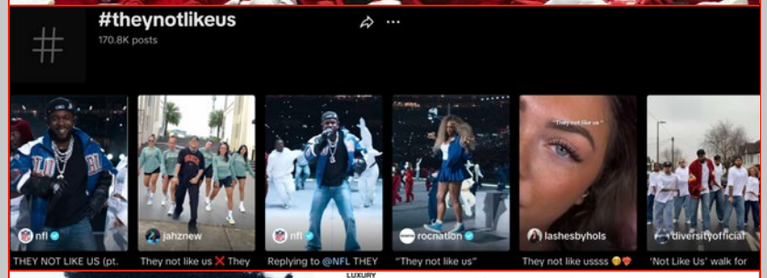
Sustained Real-World Participation

After it aired, the halftime show transformed into a living artifact with fans as key co-authors of the extended cultural conversation. TikTok creators across the globe remixed the now iconic "Not Like Us" hook into everything from choreography to memes. Fans broke the show down second by second; unpacking deep cuts spanning Lamar's ongoing beef with Drake to topical socio-political issues.

A Catalyst for Brand Repositioning

This performance didn't just shift the cultural conversation, it served to reshape Lamar's own brand identity. With calculated styling choices, including his much-discussed revival of bootcut jeans, Lamar signaled a deliberate pivot from a year of confrontation and controversy, to a new, elevated chapter, one that culminated in his most recent appointment as the new face of Chanel.







LUXURY

Exclusive: Chanel Signs Kendrick Lamar as Brand Ambassador

The American musician's unique blend of artistry, social commentary and provocation has generated cultural impact, commercial success and institutional recognition. Now, he's starring in the French brand's latest eyewear campaign.

In Focus: Google Cloud at the Sphere

REDEFINING THE STANDARD FOR B2B EXPERIENCES

At Google Cloud Next 2025 in Las Vegas, Google unveiled a groundbreaking project: a fully reimagined, AI-enhanced version of The Wizard of Oz. This initiative, developed in partnership with Sphere Entertainment Co., Magnopus, and Warner Brothers, leverages advanced generative AI to transform the classic 1939 film into an unprecedented, large-scale visual experience.

The announcement was one of the most talked-about moments of Google Cloud Next 2025, underscoring the growing role of AI in the future of entertainment, as well as the need for brands in the B2B space to leverage experience as a way to stand out.

Never-Before-Seen Visual Storytelling for B2B Selling

This immersive, buzz worthy event was paired with more extensive product demos held at the Convention Center. Customers were wowed by the spectacle but could still have hands on experience with Cloud solutions.

Cultural Resonance and Audience Engagement

Google Cloud posted a sneak peek on its official Instagram account, offering a glimpse into the ambitious project and creating anticipation through social engagement.

Ongoing Buzz and Excitement

Attendees and observers continued to discuss the event after it had happened on social media and online, sharing their excitement about the technology. The behind-the-scenes documentary footage left a lasting impression, with many citing it as a highlight of the broader conference.

Anticipation for the Public Premiere

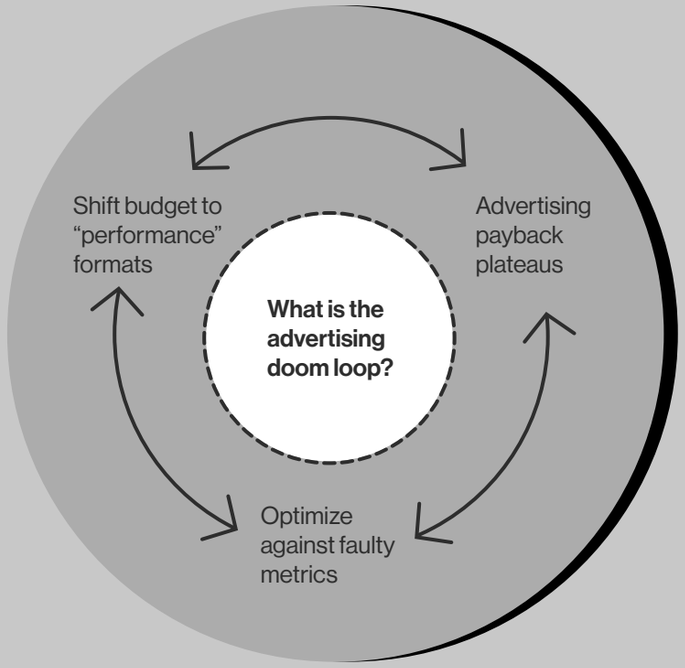
The preview generated significant anticipation for the full public debut of “The Wizard of Oz at Sphere,” scheduled for August 28, 2025.







However, measuring experience is notoriously difficult.



Forcing traditional marketing metrics onto experience to quantify its qualitative aspects like **emotional resonance, brand advocacy, and memory retention** is akin to forcing **a square peg into a round hole.** Such exercises often yield weak data, resulting in inconsequential insights and devaluing experience.

Without a clear understanding of brand objectives and a structured framework for meaningful measurement, making the case for investing in experience becomes a huge challenge for marketers.

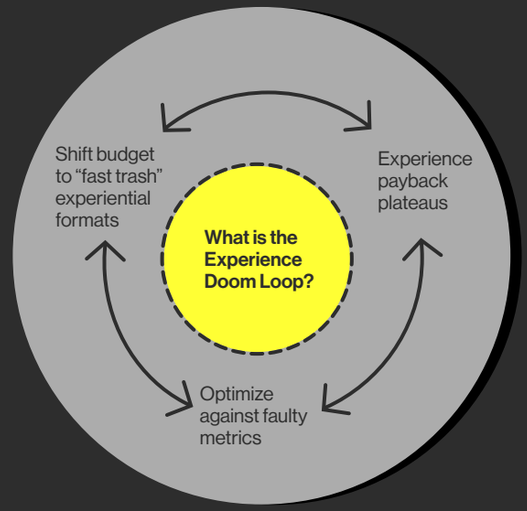
If we measure experience just like media, then it will always fall short. We enter what WARC calls an advertising doom loop focusing on optimizing for faulty metrics and prioritizing short-termism with our brand investments.

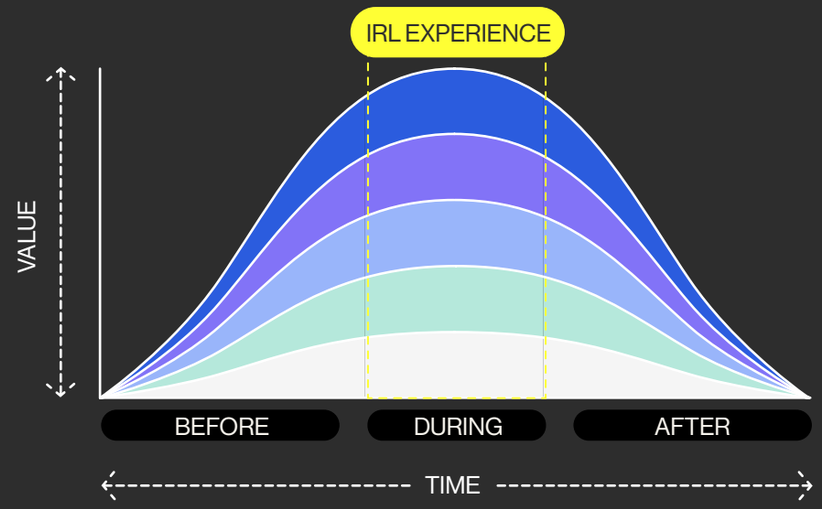
Introducing: The Return on Experience (ROX) Framework

To address this, we have developed the **Return on Experience (ROX) Framework** to help marketers and organizations invest in experiences effectively.

A SHIFT FROM

EXPERIENCE DOOM LOOP ⟶ RETURN ON EXPERIENCE





While technology and culture are transforming the role of experience in marketing, the **Return on Experience (ROX) Framework** is built upon two fundamental shifts and concepts:

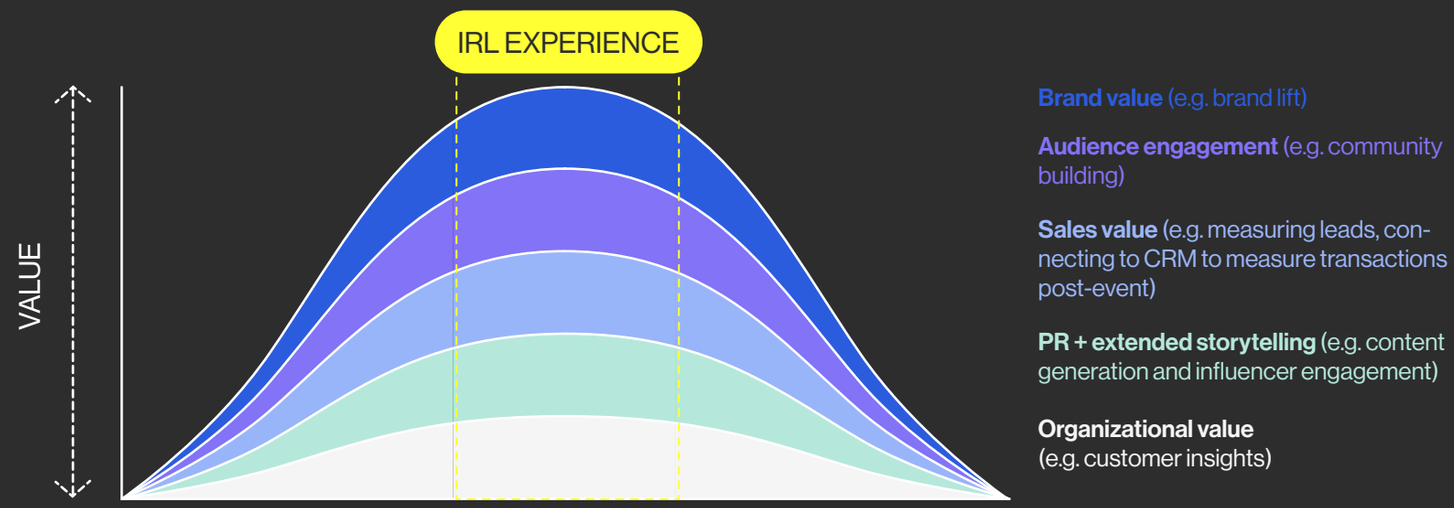
1) **Experience can create more holistic value than just marketing value** and shouldn't be measured as "media" alone.

2) **Experience must scale to achieve maximum impact** and therefore our ways of measurement should expand as well.

Moving beyond marketing value alone

Just like our example of someone watching *Dune*, what needs to be measured is the experience itself, not only the "viewing" of *Dune*.

To build our framework, let's first look at our vertical axis - and expand it to measure the value of experience holistically:

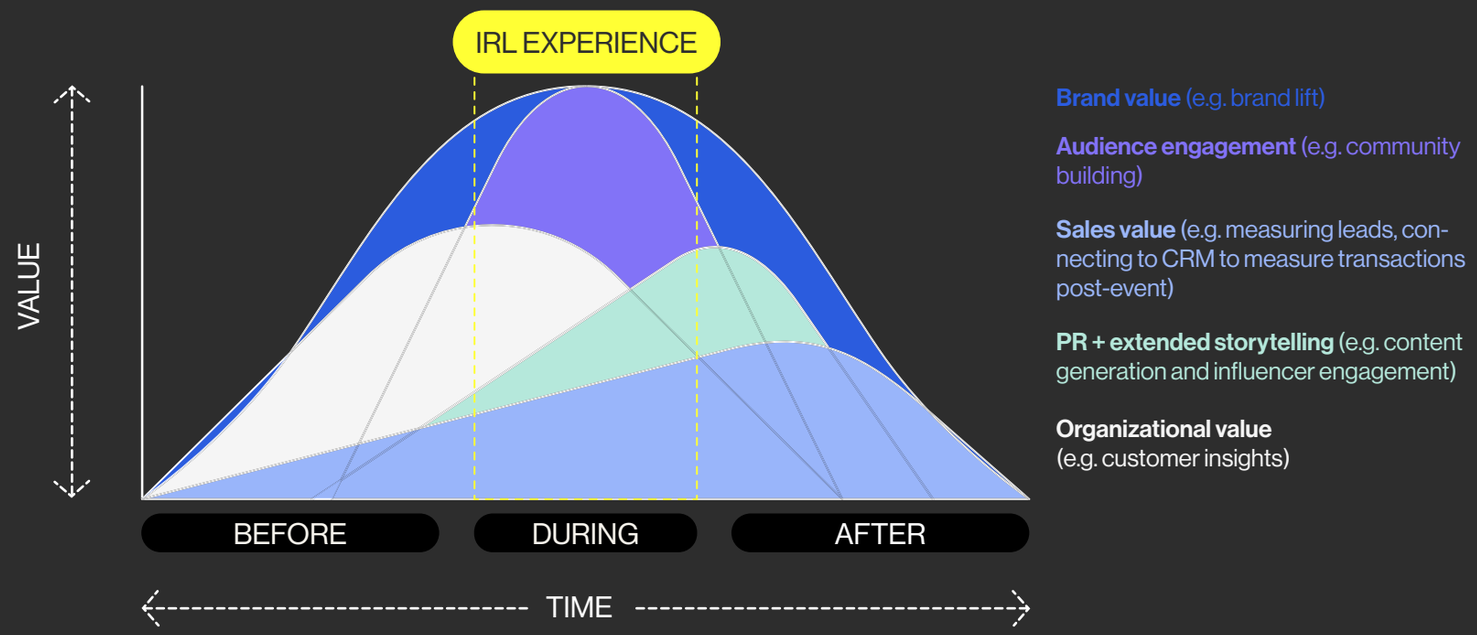


The quantitative and qualitative insights derived through this framework yield invaluable intelligence, transforming measurement from checking a box into something that delivers real strategic impact.

Scaling experience's impact over time

The experience of watching *Dune* at an IMAX theater is not just the movie, but the buzz and anticipation of the release, getting to the theater, buying popcorn, watching the movie, and buzzing about it with other fans as you leave.

So our horizontal axis represents time (before, during, and after the experience), expanding the way that we can view the value of a connected experience and make each aspect more scalable and investable.



Every experience becomes a bell curve, creating a helpful way to visualize the projected overall impact of an experience based on varying business objectives, goals and investment at different cycles and seasons.

This becomes a blueprint for longer term success, scale, and synergy between brand and audience.

Depending on each individual brand's varying business objectives, goals, and investment at different cycles, this framework can be a north star for successfully developing, executing on, and measuring experience.

"We measure things not for vanity, but to be able to learn and make things better. That means designing an approach to uncover foundational insights that can impact more than marketing, but product, sales, and even our notion of who a customer is."

—Jim Babb
CEO
Part and Sum

2. The Experience Bell Curve

How to drive higher brand value: **The vertical axis**

The first step in creating impactful experiences is understanding how to build a **higher peak of brand value –** the more emotionally resonant the experience, the greater the audience's confidence and connection to the brand, which translates to more meaningful long-term impact on brand equity.

Moving from “Experiential” to “Experience”

TO MOVE BEYOND OUTDATED EXPERIENTIAL TACTICS, BRANDS MUST EMBRACE FIVE KEY SHIFTS:

“In Marketing, the term “Experiential” implies “cheapness” and “fast trash”. When the trend kicked off, ROI was the number of people and impressions gathered. We’re now at a point where clients are fighting for attention and focus more than ever before. So when you gather people together in an Experience, you’re creating a finer funnel for engagement and strategic audience interaction”

—Michael Fullman
CCO
VTPro

1. Transactional ⟶ Transformative
Experiences must go beyond driving immediate, measurable outcomes (e.g., impressions, conversions) to fostering long-term emotional bonds and brand affinity.

2. Passive ⟶ Active Participation
The most successful experiences invite audiences to co-create, fostering a sense of agency, ownership, and deeper connection.

3. Physical ⟶ Hybrid
Blending digital and physical elements allows for greater personalization, reach, and post-event engagement.

4. Individual ⟶ Collective
Experiences that tap into shared moments create stronger emotional resonance and brand advocacy.

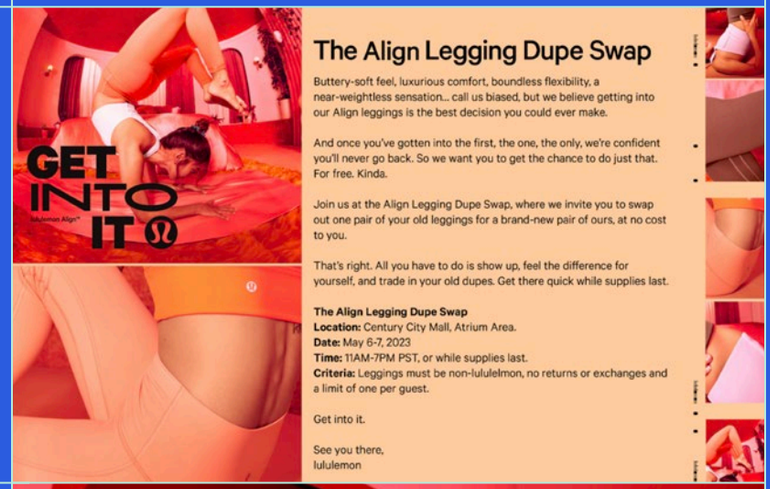
5. Momentary ⟶ Transcendent
Experiences should not be fleeting; they should embed themselves into personal narratives, creating long-lasting emotional impact.

Experience as a Peak of Brand Equity

Immersive, emotionally-resonant experiences don't just capture attention; they build trust, loyalty, and long-term brand value. At their best, these high-engagement moments become the **peak of the brand–audience relationship**: elevating brand equity and positioning experience as a true cornerstone of brand strategy.

IN FOCUS: LULULEMON DUPE SWAP

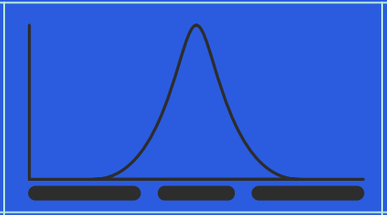
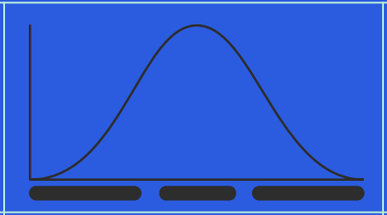
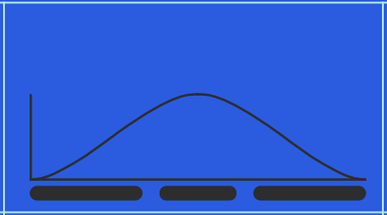
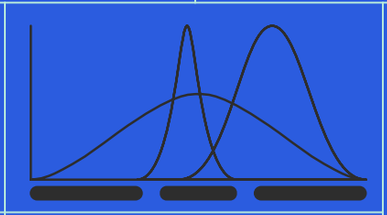
The Lululemon Dupe Swap transformed a trending TikTok conversation into a culturally resonant, emotionally-charged, and values-driven brand experience. By inviting consumers to trade in their imitation Align leggings (no questions asked) for the real thing, Lululemon tapped into the moment and turned brand imitation into brand elevation. The experience demonstrated confidence, sparked loyalty, and reinforced product superiority in a participatory, sensorial, and share-worthy way. It blurred the line between marketing and service, and in doing so, solidified deeper emotional trust with both fans and skeptics.





Extending experience beyond the moment: The horizontal axis

Depending on brand objectives, the **bell curve** of experience can take different forms:

				
Type	HIGHER PEAK	WIDER CURVE	SMOOTHER TRANSITIONS	MULTIPLE PEAKS
Overview	**Ignite:** A singular, emotionally intense moment that maximizes engagement in a concentrated window of time.	**Extend:** Longer duration engagement strategy that surrounds a core event with meaningful pre- and post-experience interactions.	**Flow:** Carefully planned moments of continuity between high peak experiences to maintain top-of-mind presence.	**Orchestrate:** A strategically orchestrated series of moments across time, platforms and/or geographies to reinforce a singular brand narrative.
What it is like for an audience to experience it? (Customer POV)	A unique, immersive moment of awe and intensity – a new memory with authentic emotional resonance.	A seamless experience that starts before the event begins, and sustains my excitement and sentiment after it's over.	Feels seamless, polished and intuitively connected to the brand. There's no abrupt "drop off" after a peak moment because I remain authentically engaged by the brand's storytelling.	The brand keeps showing up in meaningful and surprising ways; there is consistency without repetition. *I truly understand what this brand stands for.*
Best for what? (Business objectives)	Brand elevation; embedding brand in culture; social virality.	Data and insights gathering; customer education; deeper storytelling; long-term consideration; amplification.	Repeat engagement; maintaining cultural relevance over long periods of time.	Community building; brand-as-platform strategy; long-term brand equity building; generating lifetime value for audiences.
Example	**Gatorade iD at the Super Bowl:** One-time high-profile immersive brand experience that spoke authentically to different target audiences.	**Verizon NFL AR Experience:** Extended the reach of the live moment with social AR engagement pre/post event.	**Gentle Monster Retail Strategy:** Uses unique evolving spatial design and storytelling to make retail stores into destinations.	**Loewe Crafted World:** A multi-platform, multi-market, multi-format system of brand experience that reinforces the brand's lifelong dedication to craftsmanship.

2B. THE HORIZONTAL AXIS

Experience today requires a more strategic approach.

This approach allows marketers to extend engagement **before and after** the event itself, resulting in a higher return on experience. This is visualized by a wider, more gradual bell curve (connected more holistically with other marketing efforts) with a higher and more sustained impact.

BEFORE	DURING	AFTER
Build-up and anticipation — fueling excitement and engagement well before the main event or interaction.	Peak of the experience, representing the core event or interaction. Traditional experiential marketing is focused on this phase.	Modern brand experiences extend far beyond the event itself. This "long tail" represents ongoing engagement.



Teaser campaigns - Pre-event communication - Targeted messaging - Personalized invitations - Influencer partnership	**Immersive environments - Cutting-edge technology - Personalization - Active participation - Content programs (podcasts, broadcasts)**	**Follow-up communications - User-generated sharing - Advertising - Community building - Loyalty programs**

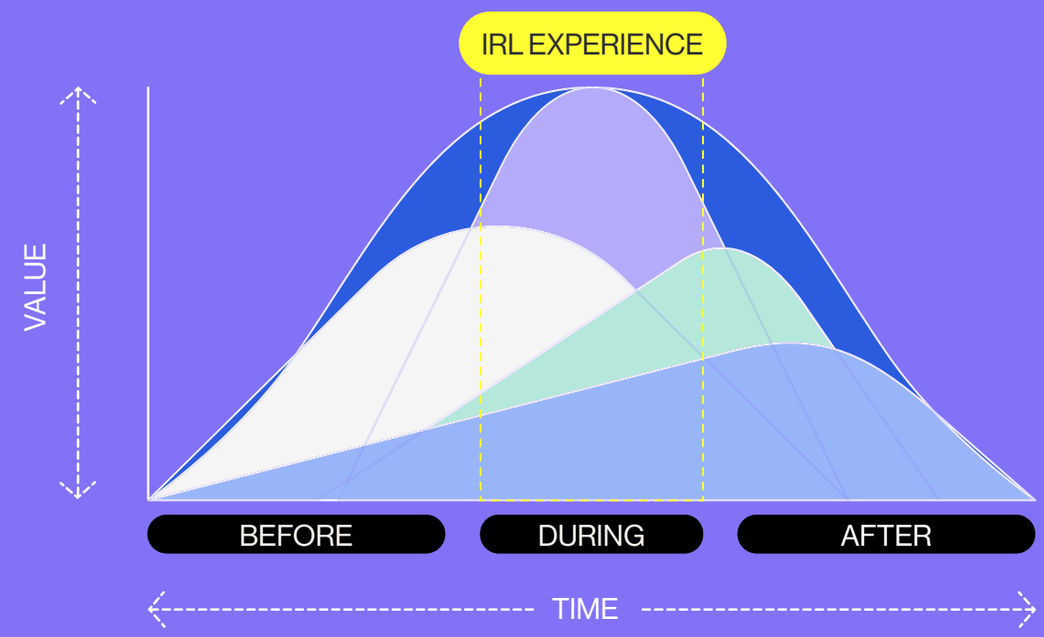
3. Measuring the Bell Curve

Holistic measurement across the experience journey

The ROX framework is grounded in the fundamental belief that an experience has the potential to provide key growth insights *beyond* marketing, before, during and after the experience itself.

"By measuring the return on experience, we are able to define and build the impact that these experiences have on the larger ecosystem of brand health and loyalty."

—Katrina Klawiter
Sr. Manager of Analytics
Part & Sum



Expanding value beyond marketing

Through a holistic and strategically-designed measurement approach that **collects and compounds quantitative and qualitative insights** across the entirety of the experience journey, we supercharge experiences to deliver maximum impact to brand:

BEFORE

Learning doesn't need to wait until the event itself. The lead up to an event can be leveraged to make the experience the best possible experience.

Example Measures

—Qualitative, validating the experience
—Engagement with pre-event communications
—Anticipation and Buzz

DURING

During the event we can measure our ability to create a meaningful experience across immersion, demo engagement, and community building.

Example Measures

—Attendee volume and time
—Engagement with different aspects of the event
—UGC, Influencer or other content created
—Earned media impressions

AFTER

We can look for event impact signals and insights, across our experience pillars, and media and content.

Example Measures

—Sales attributed to attendees
—Post-event surveys
—Social sentiment
—Social engagement with post-event content

These become the ingredients for measurable ROX recipes

Depending on the business objectives you can custom build measurable strategies for the right bell curve outcome. This will look different for each business and their audience.

A WIDER CURVE MIGHT EXTEND:

Before
Pre-event comms that generate ample buzz

During
UGC content creation at the event

After
Paid media spend allocated to event content

SMOOTHER TRANSITIONS MIGHT CREATE FLOW:

Before
Research and qualitative deep dives into audience shopping behavior

During
Longer tail retail strategy that brings PR to in-store events

After
Measurable sales lift and email strategy

3rd party platforms can be key partners to facilitate measurable impact

3rd party platforms like StackAdapt help activate 1st-party data and orchestrate connected customer journeys that can drive results across channels. By centralizing customer data in the platform brands have the opportunity to map out their experience curve through automation: pre-event email marketing, out of home placements surrounding an event location and post-event communication.

These DSP platforms and agency partners allow for AI-powered live campaign modeling to report across KPIs and channels holistically and facilitate a more intentional ROX.

StackAdapt

FLEXIBLE, INTELLIGENT TARGETING

First party audiences, proprietary contextual targeting, ABM targeting, and so much more.

CONNECT FRAGMENTED CHANNELS

Build higly-personalized programmatic and email campaigns that engage audiences through the entire buyer journey.

REMOVE DATA SILOS

Unify first-party data to create multi-channel campaigns with information-rich, relevant audiences.

ELIMINATE REPORTING GAPS

See real-time performance analytics across channels to track attribution, measure impact, and optimize spend.

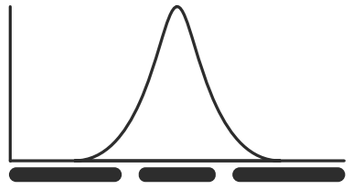
4. Case Studies: Return on Experience in Action

Return on Experience in action

Depending on brand objectives, **the bell curve** of experience can take different forms:

— Higher Peak
— Wider Curve
— Smoother Transitions
— Multiple Peaks

In this section, we spotlight experiences that bring the ROX framework to life via different shapes of the experience curve; demonstrating how strategically designed experiences can create real measurable impact.



Higher peak

More immersive and emotionally engaging core experiences will generate a higher peak during the event itself.

IN FOCUS: GATORADE ID SUPER BOWL EXPERIENCE

Overview:
To launch its new personalization platform Gatorade iD, the brand partnered with VTPro on a multi-day Super Bowl activation. The goal: reintroduce Gatorade as an innovation platform through an exclusive, high-touch experience that brought personalization and performance to life.

The Challenge:

Long known for a single hero product, Gatorade aimed to shift perception; showcasing a broader, science-driven portfolio relevant to both A-list athletes and young athletes who represent the next generation.

Strategic Objectives:

Brand Elevation:
Inspire pro athletes, high schoolers, and retail decision-makers with a fresh innovation story.

B2B Activation:
Engage key retail buyers (Kroger, 7-Eleven, etc.) with future-forward product potential.

Internal Education:
Immerse PepsiCo stakeholders in Gatorade's evolving portfolio.

The Experience:

A 3-day pop-up, positioned as a "temporary innovation center," brought Gatorade iD to life through:

—*Customization Stations* for hands-on bottle design, echoing the e-comm platform

—*RFID-powered journeys* that tracked guest behavior and engagement throughout different activation zones

—*Creator-designed bottles* that showcased Gatorade's cultural and performance relevance

—*Intelligent audience targeting* across athletes, students, retail execs, and influencers

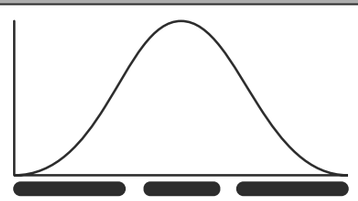
Results & Learnings:

—RFID data revealed *valuable cohort-specific insights*, driving future experience design optimisation

—Brand perception shifted toward *innovation and personalization*

—While not optimized for sales, the experience built invaluable *long-term brand equity* across target audience





Wider curve

A wider curve is created by focusing on extending audience engagement before and after the event.

IN FOCUS: VERIZON NFL AR EXPERIENCE

Overview:
To amplify NFL fandom, Verizon partnered with BUCK to launch an on-site **AR fan experience** during the 2019–2020 season. This experience was designed to activate team pride through immersive, social-first moments that expanded the fan journey beyond the game itself, building a **wider curve** of engagement before, during, and after gameday.

The Challenge:

Verizon wanted to fuel excitement in advance, deliver interactive moments onsite, and keep fan energy alive post-game, all while spotlighting the power of Verizon's 5G innovation.

Strategic Objectives:

Fan Amplification:
Give fans dynamic ways to showcase their team spirit.

Innovation Spotlight:
Demonstrate the possibilities of Verizon's 5G through engaging, high-visibility use cases.

Enabling Emotion:
Move beyond passive sponsorship to deliver meaningful, memorable fan experiences.

Extended Impact:
Create an engagement arc that stretched across the entire fan journey; not just game time

The Experience:

Verizon installed **"super-sized thrones"** at 10 different NFL stadiums themed to each home team. When fans sat on the thrones and scanned with their phones, they unlocked **team-specific AR skins**: immersive and fully customizable worlds layered with 3D graphics and entertaining effects. Fans could then capture and share their creations across social, turning pride into viral content.

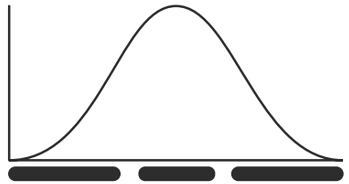
Results & Learnings:

—Expanded Social Reach and UGC

—Hybrid Impact created between physical activation and personalized digital interaction

—Shifted Brand Perception: Verizon was not just a sponsor, but a direct enabler of next-gen fan experiences





Wider curve

A wider curve is created by focusing on extending audience engagement before and after the event.

IN FOCUS: CHARLI XCX'S BRAT WALL

Overview:

To build anticipation for her 2024 album *Brat*, Charli XCX staged a surprise pop-up performance where she lip-synced atop an SUV parked in front of a lo-fi lime green wall in Greenpoint. What began as one-off guerrilla spectacle quickly evolved into a participatory fan landmark. Lovingly dubbed the "Brat Wall," the wall drew fans back daily to decode lyrics, document updates, and share content; transforming a static backdrop into a dynamic cultural touchpoint now immortalized on Google Maps.

Results:

Cultural Infiltration:

The "Brat Wall" transcended its physicality by being memed, mapped, and mythologized across various media and social platforms. The strategic location of the wall (at The Lot Radio within arts-centric Greenpoint) helped further embed *Brat* into the cultural fabric through its proximity to New York's creatives, influencers and culture-makers.

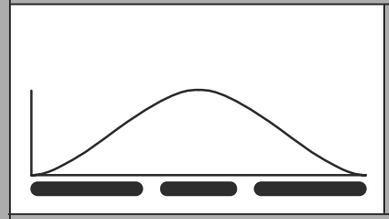
Long-Tail Engagement:

The Brat Wall extended the album's release cycle far beyond the initial PR moment. Instead of a single splashy drop, the wall sustained momentum through drip-fed lyric reveals, fan-led speculation, and repeat pilgrimages. Each visit became valuable UGC; fueling an organic feedback loop between IRL interaction and online amplification.

Authentic Community-Building:

As fans posted selfies with it, remixed it online, or referenced it in commentary, the wall blurred the boundary between content and community. It became a must-visit site for everyone who identified as *Brat*.





Smoother transitions

Seamless transitions between peaks of experience help to keep brands authentically at the top of mind.

IN FOCUS: RAY-BAN STORIES GLOBAL RETAIL CAMPAIGN

Overview:

To support the global launch of Ray-Ban Stories, VTPro partnered with Luxxotica and Meta over 2 years to reimagine retail as an experiential channel; one that could introduce smart eyewear in a way that felt tactile, aspirational, and intuitive. The result: a scalable, tiered in-store campaign deployed across 2,200 stores, offering another way for consumers to get excited about the brand and product outside of peak activations.

The Challenge:
As a new smart wearable entering the market after the likes of Google Glass and Snap Spectacles, Ray-Ban Stories needed to differentiate itself by landing at the intersection of fashion and function. It needed to be positioned not as a cold tech product, but as a fashionable lifestyle object. The retail environment had to deliver both aesthetic appeal and hands-on technical clarity. How do you sell a complex product in a way that's desirable *and* understandable?

Strategic Objectives:

Position Tech as Lifestyle:
Inspire pro athletes, high schoolers, and retail decision-makers with a fresh innovation story.

B2B Activation:
Frame Ray-Ban Stories as a must-have fashion accessory, not a niche gadget.

Make the Complex Feel Simple:
Teach customers how it works, without overwhelming them.

Embed Experience into the Path to Purchase:
Make retail more than a place to transact—it's where the brand story unfolds.

Design for Scale + Impact:
Deliver a consistent global footprint, with flexible tiers for different markets.

The Experience:

—Tiered Retail Fixtures: A scalable system, ranging from minimal graphics to immersive, fridge-sized "infinity mirror" displays, allowed stores to dial the experience up or down based on their footprint and market priority. Each version was designed to draw customers in visually while signaling innovation.

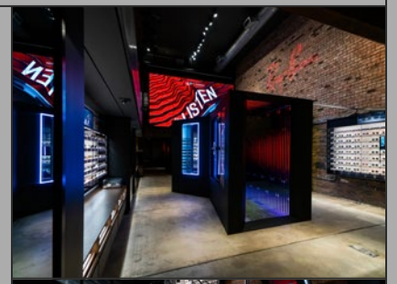
—Touchscreen Tutorials: Interactive screens integrated into the retail fixtures helped customers understand how to use the product; making the experience educational and approachable.

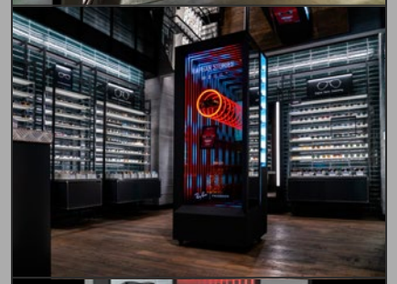
Results & Learnings:

—Retail became a *central node in the brand experience*, not just a transactional endpoint

—The multi-tiered system made it possible to maintain *consistency and creativity across 2,200 global locations*

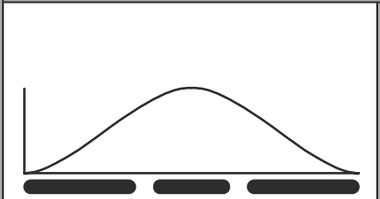
—Retail proved to be a *powerful space for onboarding new technology*, not just displaying it











Smoother transitions

Seamless transitions between peaks of experience help to keep brands authentically at the top of mind.

"A lot of the time, retail isn't the brand, it is the place where you acquire the brand. Now, in a culture of on-demand consumption with sales moving largely online, Retail has become the way you experience the brand. This footprint is now a space to exalt the brand and has become another way to communicate with audiences. Gentle Monster is a really good example of this."

—Michael Fullman
CCO
VTPro

IN FOCUS: GENTLE MONSTER'S IMMERSIVE RETAIL STRATEGY

Overview:
Gentle Monster, the South Korean eyewear brand, has disrupted retail by transforming its stores into immersive art spaces. These experiential environments serve as continuous engagement points, maintaining brand momentum between major marketing campaigns and product launches. By integrating art, storytelling, and technology, Gentle Monster ensures that each retail visit is a unique experience, reinforcing its brand identity and keeping it top of mind for consumers.

The Challenge:

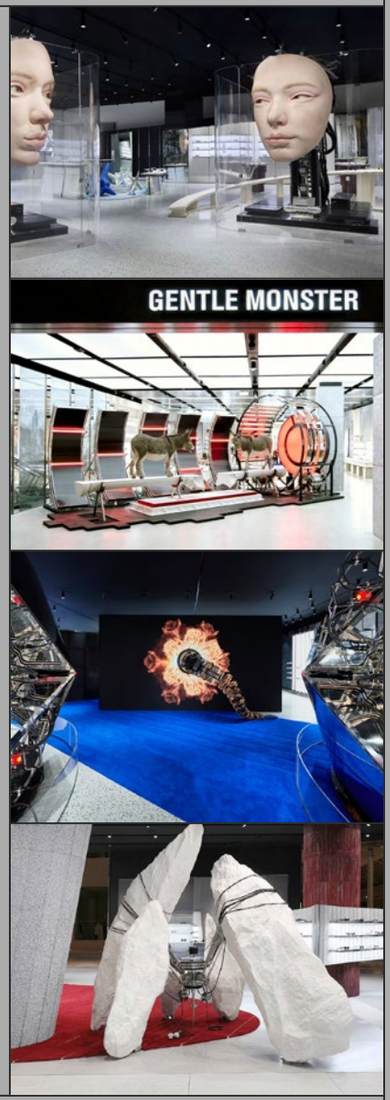
The eyewear industry has long been dominated by giants like EssilorLuxottica, creating a homogenous market in both design and retail. To break through this monopoly, Gentle Monster had to think differently. They positioned eyewear as a cultural object rather than a commodity. By leaning into immersive, art-driven retail and bold design, the brand charted an entirely new path in an otherwise saturated market.

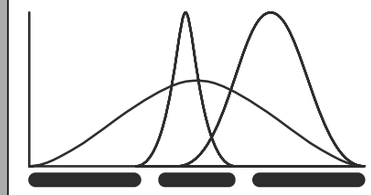
The Experience:

Immersive Retail:
Every Gentle Monster store is themed, with installations regularly refreshed to encourage repeat visits and social media shares.

Sensory Storytelling:
Lighting, sound, kinetic sculptures, and mixed media are combined to create deeply atmospheric spaces that feel closer to theatrical/ art installations than retail.

According to Experiential Retail Studies, 45% of Gentle Monster customers visit stores primarily for the immersive art experience, with many describing it as a key factor in their brand loyalty.





Multiple peaks

Seamless transitions between peaks of experience help to keep brands authentically at the top of mind.

IN FOCUS: LOEWE'S CRAFTED WORLD CAMPAIGN

Overview:
Loewe's Crafted World is a multifaceted global campaign that underscores the brand's unwavering commitment to craftsmanship. Through a series of interconnected experiences spanning exhibitions, digital platforms, publications, and localized content, Loewe has crafted a cohesive narrative that celebrates its deep artisanal heritage and contemporary innovation.

The Challenge:

In an era where luxury brands often rely on fleeting trends, Loewe sought to establish a lasting and authentic dialogue with its audience. The objective was to create a series of touchpoints that not only highlight the brand's dedication to craftsmanship but also engage diverse audiences across diverse platforms and geographies.

The Experiences:

—Crafted World Exhibitions: Debuting in Shanghai (2024) and subsequently in Tokyo (2025), these immersive exhibitions offer visitors a journey through Loewe's 179-year history, blending fashion, art, and interactive installations.

—Digital Companion Experience: Developed by Stink Studios, the digital platform extends the exhibition's reach, offering interactive elements like personalized toolboxes, games, and quizzes, all integrated with LINE for seamless user engagement.

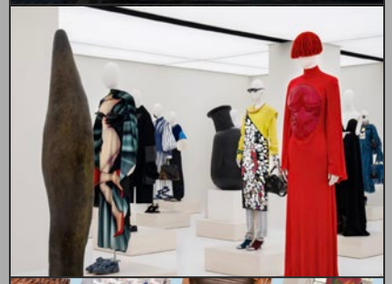
—Crafted World Monograph: A 636-page limited-edition book, "Crafted World: Jonathan Anderson's Loewe," chronicles a decade of Anderson's creative direction, featuring iconic designs, BTS insights, and contributions from key collaborators.

—Loewe Craft Prize: An annual award celebrating contemporary artisans, reinforcing Loewe's dedication to the craft community and spotlighting emerging talents.

Loewe's Crafted World exemplifies how a brand can create a series of interconnected and reinforcing experiences to build a compelling and enduring narrative. This approach doesn't just celebrate the brand's heritage, but also sustains engagement and resonance with global audiences.









In Sum: ROX is the new ROI for experience.

From retail activations to touring exhibitions, the strongest brands today don't just market to audiences; they invite them into their world, co-create with them, and show up consistently across different moments and mediums.

The best experiences:

— Move from **transactional to transformative**
— Invite **active participation**
— Blend **physical and digital**
— Create **shared cultural moments**
— Embed themselves in **memory, not just media**

Most importantly, when experience is treated as a strategy and not just "fast trash", it has the power to generate vast return on experience, measured in value across marketing, brand, sales, and organizational growth.

6. Applying it to You: Making the Case for Experience

Evaluating your last experience

Seamless transitions between peaks of experience help to keep brands authentically at the top of mind.

What was the business objective of our last experience?
What measures did we track?
What was most successful or valuable to our brand?
What did we learn?
What do we wish we had learned?
From an audience perspective, what was the most valuable thing we did?
What would we do differently next time?

Designing Your Own ROX

For innovative marketers looking to invest more in experiences, baking-in ROX into your overall marketing strategies and plans means that you can not only create more value, but you'll be able to better prove that value across your organization.

Start by answering these questions, and use the following cheat sheets (for B2C and B2B activations) to pull the types of measures that will be most valuable to your organization and unlock the appropriate investment.

Make sure to include these expectations of proving ROX in your briefings to agencies, vendors and partners.

Together we can make better experiences.

7 ROX QUESTIONS FOR INNOVATIVE MARKETERS

1. What is our business objective?
Why is an experience the best way to deliver on it?

2. What type of experience (bell curve size and shape) will best deliver it for us?

3. What marketing value do we want to create?
What other types of value will this experience create for us?

4. What is the monetary value to cost breakdowns of each strategy and approach (i.e. content creation, customer research)?

5. How do we extend the value we create beyond the event / moment itself?

6. What are the specific measure we will use to prove this value?

B2C — Measurement Cheat Sheet

Based on your business objectives and experience design maturity, these are a few ideas you can measure to maximize your learnings in B2C context.

	BEFORE	DURING	AFTER
Brand Value	—Baseline awareness (longitudinal or market level pre-event survey) —Baseline sentiment —Share of search or voice	—In-person brand survey (include NPS score)	—Post-event share of search or voice —Brand lift (post-event survey) —Sentiment lift
Audience Engagement	—Social follower size —Growth and engagement rate —Social reach (teaser content) —Email list size —Growth and open rates	—Attendance volume —UGC creation —Experience engagement —Dwell time —In-person email list growth	—Growth in social followers —Social reach and engagement rates (post-event content) —Growth and engagement in email list
Sales	—Baseline sales volume —Product trends —PoP sales trends	—Spike in sales or commerce at experience, particularly if there is a limited item launched along with the experience	—Long tail change is sales volume —Sales growth rates —Directly attributed sales to event attendees via first party data
PR + Extended Storytelling	—Press and influencer features promoting the experience	—Live press and influencer coverage at the event —Influencer attendance and amplification —Total content produced at event	—Extended coverage or analysis of the experience —Earned media impressions —Owned media impressions
Organizational Value	—Preliminary customer survey —Focus groups tracking brand perception —Creative validation of the experience itself	—In-person survey tracking sentiment —Zero Party data collection —Qualitative analysis and understanding of audiences	—Perceptual shifts: change in perception, language or descriptions of the brand

B2B — Measurement Cheat Sheet

Based on your business objectives and experience design maturity, these are a few ideas you can measure to maximize your learnings in B2B context.

	BEFORE	DURING	AFTER
Brand Value	Baseline awareness (longitudinal or market level pre-event survey) Baseline sentiment Share of search or voice	—In-person brand survey (include NPS score)	—Post-event share of search or voice —Brand lift (post-event survey) —Sentiment lift
Audience Engagement	—Social follower size —Growth and engagement rate —Social reach (teaser content) —CRM list size —CRM engagement rates	—Attendance volume —UGC creation —Experience engagement —Dwell time —CRM growth	—Growth in social followers —Social reach and engagement rates (post-event content) —Growth and engagement in CRM —Thought leadership engagement
Sales	—Baseline sales volume —Product trends —PoP sales trends	—Specific customer intelligence —Conversations with sales team	—Attributed sales to CRM / experience attendees (30, 60, 90 days later)
PR + Extended Storytelling	—Press and influencer features promoting the experience	—Live press and influencer coverage at the event —Influencer attendance and amplification —Total content produced at event	—Extended coverage or analysis of the experience —Earned media impressions —Owned media impressions
Organizational Value	—Preliminary customer survey —Focus groups tracking brand perception —Creative validation of the experience itself	—In-person survey tracking sentiment —Zero Party data collection —Qualitative analysis and understanding of audiences	—Deeper understanding of customers —Enhanced customer data in CRM

6. APPLYING IT TO YOU

PART and SUM

Part and Sum is a strategic growth partner bringing together strategy, media, data and analytics to maximize your brand, product, and marketing investments.

VTProDesign

VTPro is a Los Angeles based studio pioneering story driven experiences through design, creative technology, and integrated production.

The team has collaborated with brands like Gatorade, Netflix, and McDonald's to deliver one-of-a kind interactive campaigns.

Residence

Residence is a global creative network - including Part and Sum and VTProDesign - built to champion remarkable work while empowering the community behind it.

Looking to design or measure a world class experience?

Let us help!

We can hold a custom ROX session internally for your team.

Contact us at
hello@partandsum.com